

"The Greatest Expedition you will ever undertake is the journey to self-understanding, for the real voyage of discovery consists not in seeking new lands, but in seeing with new eyes."

DANIEL J COMP

AN INTERACTIVE - AI GUIDED - SELF-MASTERY EXPEDITION FOR LEAVING

SCOTOMAVILLE



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[Filmed on location \(tour map\):](#)
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The desire to understand ourselves, to unravel the mystery of **WIDWID**—Why I Do What I Do—connects us all. It’s a question I have pursued by cycling across America on three inspiring Journeys with a Purpose.

After decades of mishaps and 50,000 miles dragging an Airstream I no longer view **Know Thyself** as a luxury or a full-out competition with AI. With a team of like-minded thinkers (a self-defined minyan) empowered by a super-reasoning engine, I am becoming a thought leader and a sage celebrating the later execution phases of my Personal Everest with the help of a digital Sherpa.

Remember your first journey? I was hopeful yet unprepared, like a Fiat 500 strapped with a useless burden on my back. At first, this image represented my idealistic youthful exploration, a journey both underpowered and naive. Recently, I discovered a double meaning in the word ‘Fiat’ itself. Beyond the name of a car, it refers to a decree, an authoritative commandment. In my journey, these were the self-imposed life commandments from false conclusions I formed of misspoken judgments that had shaped my worldview. It was as if the very mascot of my exploration challenged me to escape the self-tyranny of my thinking. W.H. Murray noted we experience ‘**all manner of unforeseen incidents and meetings and material assistance, which no man could have dreamt would have come his way.**’ The discovery of the Fiat’s symbolic richness was one such unforeseen incident that deepened my journey.

Let Scotomaville guide you on your ‘Personal Everest,’ empowering you to share your wisdom and warning and to muster the courage to champion the rapidly accelerating changes we face. Join me by turning the life you inherited into the outcomes you design.

August 10, 2023

Dirty Gas

AUTHORS + ABSTRACT



AUTHORS CURATORS

Daniel believes; **“The Greatest Expedition you will ever undertake is the journey to self-understanding, for the real voyage of discovery consists not in seeking new lands, but in seeing with new eyes.”** He is a respected husband, father, entrepreneur, and Navy Veteran. He’s demonstrated decades of sacrificial commitment to human achievement using core principles, perseverance, and resourcefulness.

Angelina is the wife of a highly functioning Asperger (me) and co-founder with me of Intelligent Netware. She is twice awarded by the U.S. S.B.A. In 2004, she sustained a TBI five days before filming for the Apprentice III. Angelina is the Founder of Wellness by Choice and a mom with a mission - bent on educating and empowering the masses on how to live smarter and healthier.

SCOTOMAVILLE ABSTRACT

■ BACKGROUND - WWDWWD

Most people respond to chaos and stress with coping mechanisms, amygdala hijackings, and reactive behavior. For some of us, curiosity dominates. We want to know **“Why We Do What We Do.”** and are committed to exploring the unknown... to ‘Know Thyself’. The Author cycled across America three times asking this.

The pandemic has challenged us with hardships, losses, setbacks, missed opportunities, and personal drama. ⁽¹⁾ Americans are weary of rapidly accelerating change.

We are flooded with messaging that games our biological and psychological bents ⁽²⁾. Emotions easily overwhelm our reasoning to control our actions. We’re further conflicted by being 100% wrong 50% of the time. ⁽³⁾ ⁽⁴⁾

We’re hoodwinked and bamboozled by tech, media, and popular narratives using trickery, flattery, and omission. ⁽⁵⁾ The adage to ‘Know Thyself’ is no longer a luxury. It’s become a full-out competition with supercomputers pointed at our brains. ⁽⁶⁾

■ METHODS - IMPARTATION

The Scotomaville program deploys the unique IMPARTATION METHODOLOGY, designed to guide participants in self-reflection and personal growth through video modeling. This methodology unfolds in a structured manner:

I Do - You Watch:

Drawing from our extensive experience as pioneers in the media, marketing, and web technology sectors since 1997, we video-journal our personal ‘journey with purpose’. Through these recordings, we share and demonstrate 15 invaluable mental tools, tests, and insights that enable resilience in facing challenges. Participants, armed with just a smartphone, can emulate our perseverance as we navigate adversities such as Traumatic Brain Injury, PTSD, and more.

We Do - We Watch:

The program is more than just watching; it’s engaging. Fifty-three episodes are complemented by a comprehensive 400+ page guide, enriched with opportunities for online discussions. Subscribers benefit from peer support, mentoring, and personalized guidance. Furthermore, the extensive digital reach, spanning over 4500 affiliated websites, allows for participant and sponsor recognition.

You Do - I Watch:

The Scotomaville journey doesn’t end with passive learning. Upcoming offerings include transformative base camp summits, private retreats, and expeditions for leaders. With the program’s licensed platform, certified leaders can guide individuals and groups, encouraging them to tread the transformative path we demonstrate.

■ FINDINGS - SELF-GAMING

By climbing a ‘Personal Everest’ and testing for oneself, the claims of W.H. Murray, and the Authors that Expeditions are filled with **“unforeseen incidents and meetings and material assistance, which no one could have dreamt would have come their way”** ⁽⁹⁾ you can develop clarity, stability, healing, and successes by gaming your biases.

Self-mastery begins with awareness of one’s physical and mental self. When combined with understanding, support, and discipline, incremental character change transforms one’s beliefs, attitudes, and behavior.

SCOTOMAVILLE reveals the intricate interdependence between our gut and brain, demonstrating how sleep patterns and stress levels influence our choices. By emphasizing the perils of tackling challenges solo and showcasing actionable insights and examples, the program empowers individuals to recognize and navigate their inherent cognitive biases.

■ CONCLUSION - PERSONAL EVEREST

A ‘Personal Everest’ is a journey with a purpose. **“But at least learn your inability... and ask the remedy for it. Learn of those who have been bound like you... These are people who know the way which you would follow, and who are cured of an ill of which you would be cured. Follow the way by which they began...”**

Blaise Pascal - Pascals Wager ⁽¹⁰⁾

A Personal Everest is a journey with a purpose. It is a self-defined expedition of personal development, with support and guidance from peers and the Author, and analysis by AI.

SCOTOMAVILLE is an unconventional and effective self-help model and platform with a convincing challenge: We can change our life experiences by gaming our own handicaps, strengthening alliances, challenging our shortcomings and changing our false beliefs by taking on our Personal Everest.

(1) <https://pubmed.ncbi.nlm.nih.gov/33711676/>

(2) <https://www.ncbi.nlm.nih.gov/pmc/articles/PMC8402266/>

(3) https://www.ted.com/talks/kathryn_schulz_on_being_wrong/transcript

(4) <https://www.amazon.co.uk/Yossi-Yassour/e/B08XJNFCNK/>

(5) <https://www.humanetech.com/who-we-are#team>

(6) <https://www.wired.com/video/watch/yuval-harari-tristan-harris-humans-get-hacked>

(7) <https://intelligentnetware.com>

(8) <https://scotomaville.com/digital-locations>

(9) https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/W._H._Murray

(10) https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Pascal%27s_wager

01

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SCOTOMA

FROM BIRTH OUR BIOLOGY BETRAYS OUR AWARENESS. SEEING THE WORLD AS IT REALLY IS REQUIRES A SHIFT IN OUR BELIEFS. THIS EXERSIZE WILL DO IT.

“WHEN WE ARE NO LONGER ABLE TO CHANGE A SITUATION, WE ARE CHALLENGED TO CHANGE OURSELVES.”
HOLOCAUST SURVIVOR VIKTOR FRANKL

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PATTERN RECOGNITION

OUR 20 WATT BRAIN IS WIRED TO CUT CORNERS AND JUMP TO CONCLUSIONS.

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MISPERCEPTION

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ONION PEELING

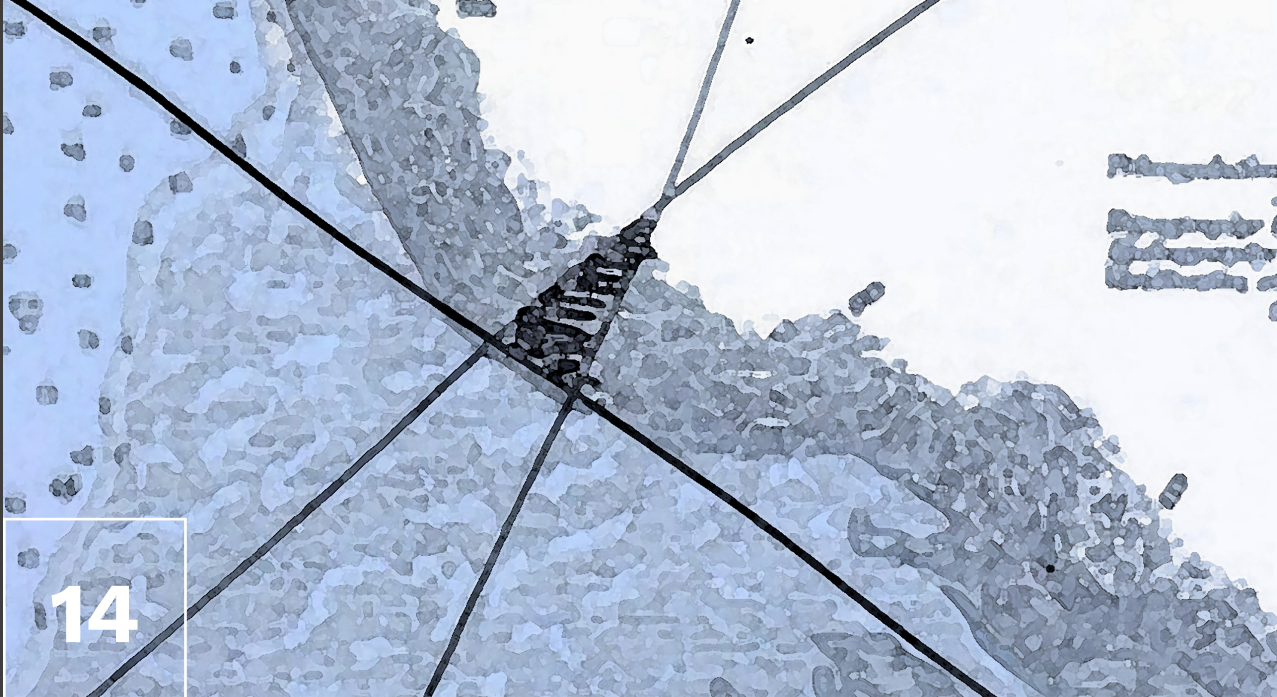
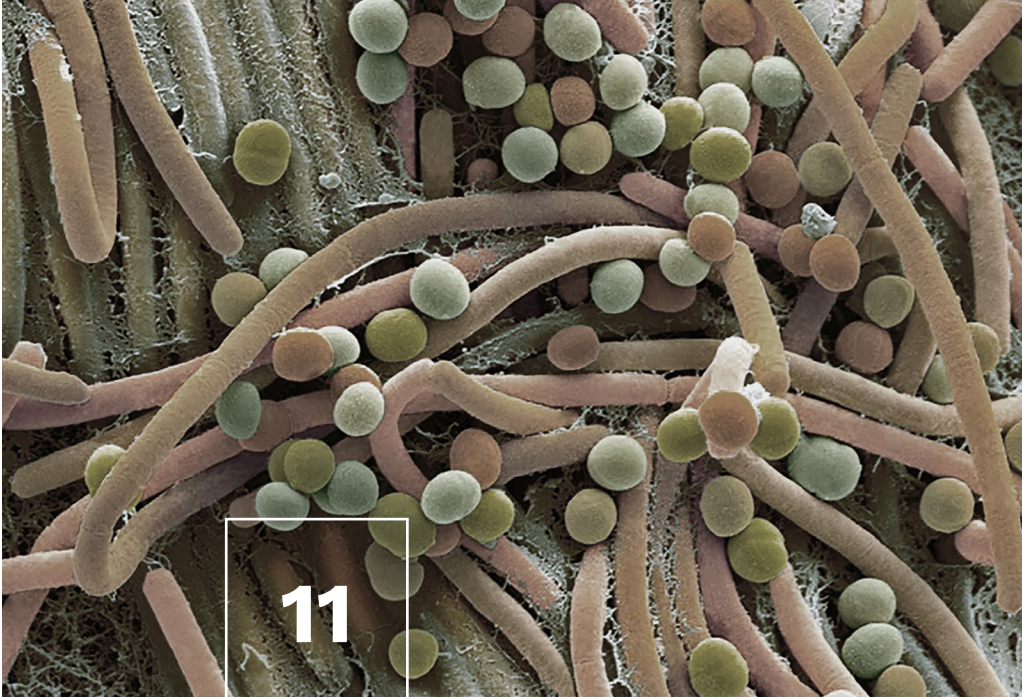
WDIDWID? WHY DO I DO WHAT I DO? MASTER THIS SKILL AND YOU’LL GET OUT OF SCOTOMAVILLE.

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WITH POWER COMES RESPONSIBILITY. LEARN TO THROTTLE YOUR ATTENTION AND FOCUS.



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WHEN YOU CAN HEAR YOUR INNER VOICE THEN YOU CAN ESCAPE WALLED GARDENS.

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YOU AND I ARE 90% MICROBE AND ONLY 10% HUMAN. THERE'S A COUP UNDERWAY. EXPOSE IT WITH A SIMPLE QUESTION - WHEN YOU LOOK DOWN - DO YOU SEE YOUR SHOES OR YOUR GUT?

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2.12

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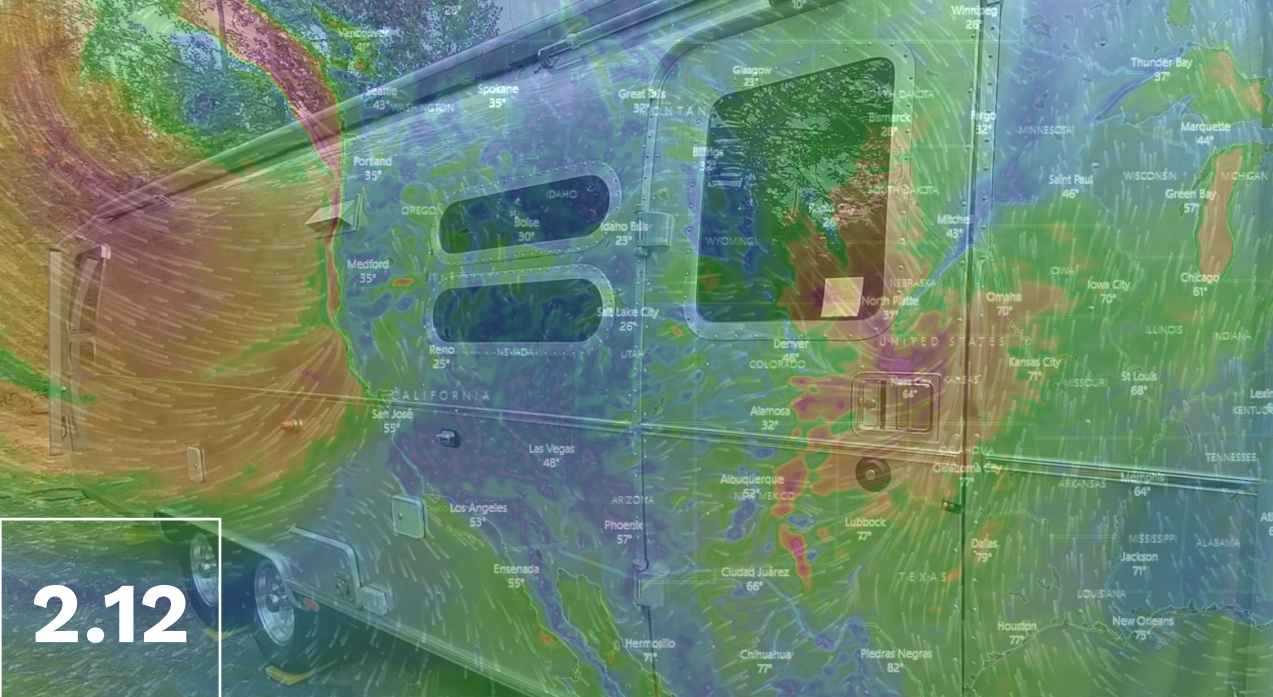
LIVING ‘THE DREAM’ COMES WITH SURPRISES. UNWRAP YOUR PSYCHOLOGY AND PHYSIOLOGY BY MIMICKING WELLNESS AND LONGEVITY.

2.13

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STORIES

WE BEGIN LIFE WITH THE STORY WE ARE HANDED. FORTUNATELY, THAT’S NOT THE END OF OUR TALE.



3.00

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QUICK START

EXPECTING OTHERS TO FOLLOW ISN'T FREEDOM OR WISE. PIVOTING AWAY FROM AN ERROR IS. THE REWARD IS IN GIVING YOUR FREEDOM TO OTHERS.

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A MENTAL ADVISORY BOARD FOR AI TO REFLECT, ASSESS, AND ADVISE. IMAGINE THE PEERS YOU WANT TO MIRROR AND GIFT THEM PURSUASIVE POWER.

3.07

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EVERY HERO HAS A CHALLENGE. THE BEST OF US EXPRESS GENES AS A RESULT

3.08

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THERE'S A CURVE AHEAD. I'M CERTAIN OF THIS.

2.13

AVATAR CHARACTER BY JAMES CAMERON
"ALL YOU HAVE TO DO IS PICK UP A CAMERA AND
START SHOOTING SOMETHING WITH THE INTENTION
OF MAKING A FILM AND YOU'RE A FILMMAKER"

STORIES

"I THINK IT'S THE DUTY OF FILMMAKERS THAT HAVE BEEN DOWN THE ROAD AWAYS TO TURN AROUND AND SAY; ALL RIGHT THERE'S A LAND MINE OVER HERE. THERE'S A LANDMINE OVER THERE. DON'T STEP ON THEM. SO WHY NOT SHARE THAT."

JAMES CAMERON

THE STORIES WE TELL OURSELVES

I'm taking a MasterClass from the filmmaker James Cameron.

James: "When I started out I was working as a truck driver. I didn't have much spare cash and certainly couldn't afford film school.

"But all you have to do is pick up a camera and start shooting something with the intention of making a film and you're a filmmaker.

"I think it's the duty of filmmakers that have been down the road away to turn around and say; all right there's a land mine over here. There's a landmine over there. Don't step on it. So why not share that.

"I'm James Cameron. This is my MasterClass."

Wow. It's pretty amazing when you get to shadow, and learn from, someone who's been where you want to go.

I hope you see the parallels.

Welcome to another Episode of SCOTOMAVILLE. In this episode, we'll talk about stories. I don't mean storytelling. I mean the stories you have built your life around. The stories that we've been told and that we tell ourselves.

I fully believe that storytelling is a superpower. AI has learned from humans how to tell convincing, emotionally rich stories, and as of the Third Edition, ChatGPT slightly lags humans in storytelling.

(Humans 9/10 - AI 6/10 see pg 330)

You learned the difference between a 'runny nose' and 'smelly feet.' Think about it. Runny Nose. Smelly Feet. (not running feet and smelly nose) AI is learning inference, humor, tone, sentiment, analogy, metaphor, and sarcasm, but it currently lacks emotional intelligence, context awareness, and experiential knowledge.

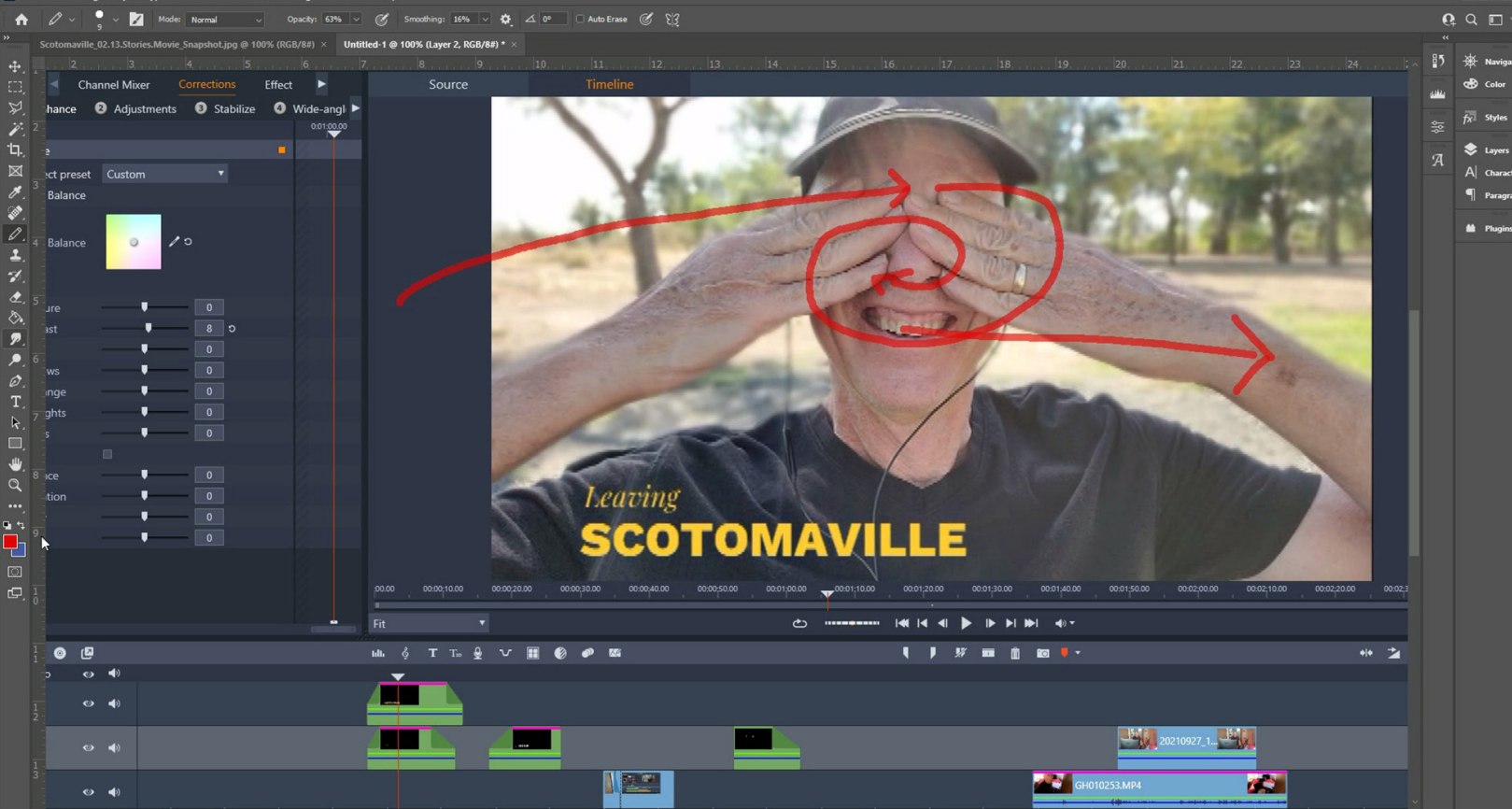


AI, help me out. My narrative is messy:

"Certainly, Daniel. Our brains, molded and

honed by evolution, are fine-tuned to survive. They alert us, like an age-old tale, to avoid danger, to "not step on this," to be wary and aware. We learn from stories that whisper caution into our very being.

But how do we choose the stories that resonate with us? It's an emotional connection, an alignment with certain key points that find a home in our minds and hearts. These stories lay the groundwork for our beliefs. Our brains seek out con-



firmation, strengthening these beliefs, revisiting and reinforcing them with new thoughts and experiences. The ideas become a well-worn path, the electrical firing across dendrite pathways turning habitual, forging the attitudes that guide our actions.

Just as James Cameron utilizes storyboards to direct a film, we do the same in our minds, playing both the audience and the director, scripting our future self.

Yet, in this grand narrative of life, we must be cautious. To escape the trap of a poorly formed belief or the relentless cycle of emotional triggers, we must recognize and understand the stories that have shaped us. We must step back, examine the script,

and ask ourselves: *What stories have influenced me? What paths have I tread so often that they've become my reality?*

By doing so, we can begin to rewrite our own story, analyzed by AI, informed by wisdom, guided by self-awareness, and inspired by the connection that binds us all through the ancient and eternal art of storytelling.”

My Harvard School Bus

I commuted to work on a bus while reading 50 volumes of the

Harvard Classics. They filled my mind with all kinds of ideas that represent some of the best of human thinking - equal to a degree from Harvard. Many of the authors are my current minyan.

The stories I appreciate most are from volume 17 on folklore and fable. I was mentored by Aesop, Grim and Anderson. I particularly favored tales with morals and consequences. The stories we tell ourselves are woven from the stories that we were told.

“The stories we tell ourselves come from the stories that we were told.”

One of the most compelling stories I recall is ‘The Cracked Pot.’ I read this story in *Chicken Soup For The Unsinkable Soul* sometime around 1999. It made a massive impression on me.

STORY 1: THE CRACKED POT

A water bearer in India had two large pots, each hung on each end of a pole which he carried across his neck. One of the pots had a crack in it, and while the other pot was perfect and always delivered a full portion of water at the end of the long walk from the stream to the master’s house, the cracked pot arrived only half full.

For a full two years this went on daily, with the bearer delivering only one and a half pots full of water in his master’s house. Of course, the perfect pot was proud of its accomplishments. But the poor cracked pot was ashamed of its own imperfections, and miserable that it was able to accomplish only half of what it had been made to do.

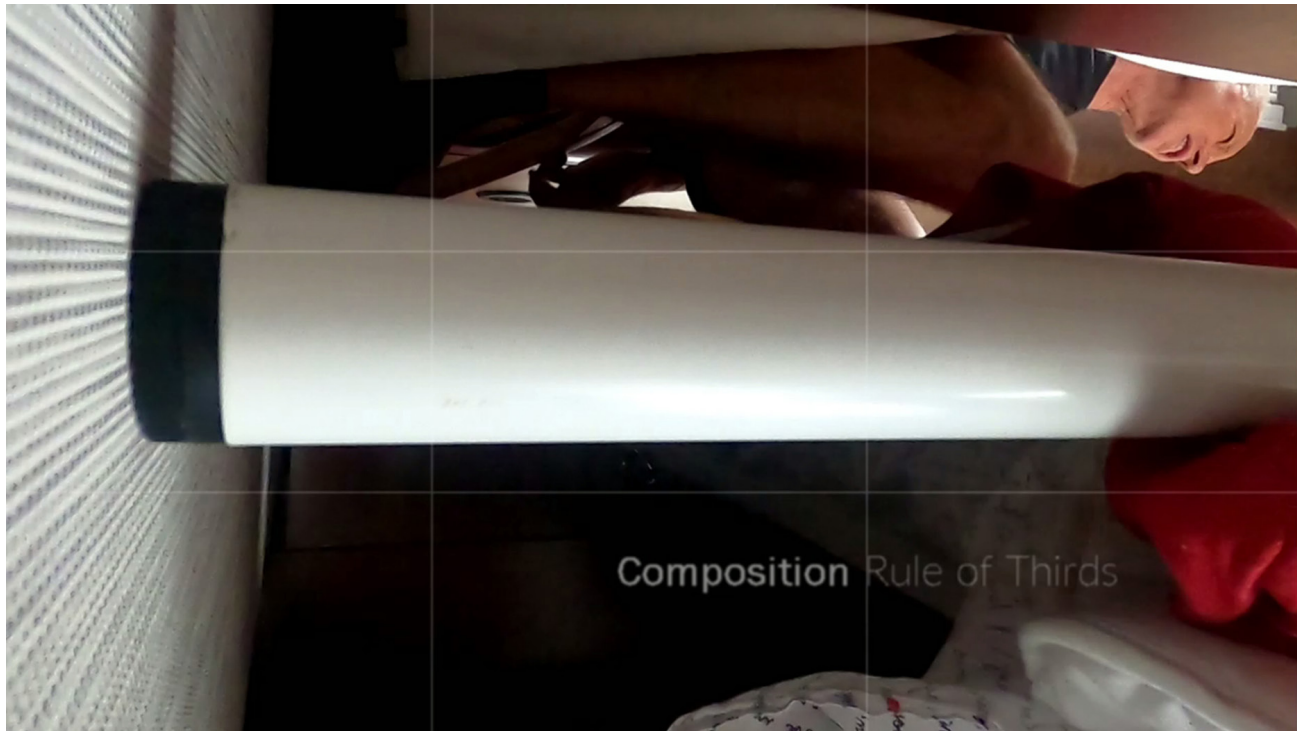
After two years of what it perceived to be a bitter failure, it spoke to the water bearer one day by the stream. “I am ashamed of myself, and I want to apologize to you.” “why?” asked the bearer. “What are you ashamed of?” I have been able, for these past two years, to deliver only half my load because this crack in my side causes water to leak out all the way back to your master’s house. Because of my flaws, you have to do all of this work and you don’t get full value for your efforts,” the pot said.

The water bearer felt sorry for the old cracked pot and in his compassion he said, “as we return to the master’s house I want you to notice the beautiful flowers along the path.”

Indeed, as they went up the hill, the old cracked pot took notice of the sun warming the beautiful wild flowers on the side of the path, and this cheered it some. But at the end of the trail, it still felt bad because it had leaked out half its load, and so again it apologized to the bearer for its failure.

ROMAN MILK POT FOUND IN SW England:
The vessel, held together with lead staples was repaired nearly 2,000 years ago. It’s thought to have been used for storing milk and dry goods.





The bearer said to the pot, “did you notice that there were flowers only on your side of the path but not on the other pot’s side? That’s because I have always known about your flaw, and I took advantage of it. I planted flower seeds on your side of the path, and every day while we walk back from the stream, you’ve watered them. For two years I have been able to pick these beautiful flowers to decorate my master’s table. Without you being just the way you are, he would not have this beauty to grace his house.”

MEANING FOR ME

I recognize the scotoma that ‘the cracked pot’ had in my thinking. For most of my life, I felt ashamed by my origins and my illegitimacy. Those in authority planted emotional seeds by speaking harsh words and condemnation, maturing the weeds in my belief system. I misunderstood their wounds and gave their words far too much credibility. I absorbed their authoritative words as truth - that I was not eligible, not worthy, not one of them, not credible.

Nurturing a patch of weeds, I tended to pull back when I ran into challenges instead of finding the good in...

oh, come on...#@!

(triggered by the camera falling)

It will probably take you several iterations and adjustments to get the camera at a pleasing angle and securely attached.

Give yourself a contingency of grace and production time for being emotionally engaged with your Personal Everest.

It takes a lot of practice and self-edification to become competent at videography. Getting the cameras rolling with good composition, exposure, and color while maintaining a calm demeanor for numerous takes of the point you are attempting to express..

STORY 2: TWO SHOES SALESMEN

Once upon a time, a shoe company sent two salesmen to Africa to determine the market potential for their products. One salesman was sent to the east coast of Africa, while the other salesman was sent to the west coast of Africa.

Both the salesmen completed a survey of the target market and called back to the office. The salesman sent to the east coast of Africa reported: “**no one here wears any shoes, there is no market for us here!**”. The other salesman sent a message “**no one here wears any shoes, there is a huge market for us, send inventory fast!**”.

COMPOSITION RULE OF THIRDS

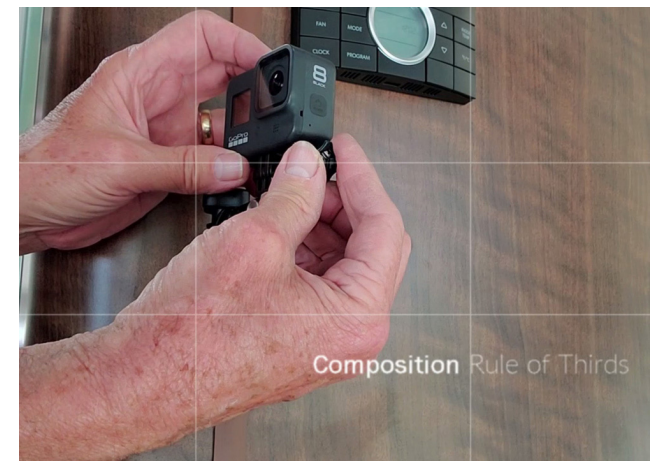
About three decades ago was the first time I had heard a story with the moral of the glass half full or glass half empty - depending on your point of view.

To show that life and all stories are far more complicated, you’ll find another version of the story in Google entitled: the two shoe salesmen (the rest of an entrepreneurial myth) from Blog Spot and the occasional CEO. The same story is told from the perspective of a corporate Chief Executive Officer.

The author tells the story again, claiming he has the ‘rest of the story.’

Note: the ‘rest of the story’ is also fiction. For privacy sake, the blogger claims he read a manuscript leaked by an unnamed source at an unknown museum, written by a daughter for privacy sake... Yeah right. Onus Probandi!

“I had a chance to read a copy of the manuscript sent me by a friend who works at the museum. Here is the rest of this classic story captured by the daughter of one salesman. For privacy’s sake...”



(Blah blah... narrative continues)

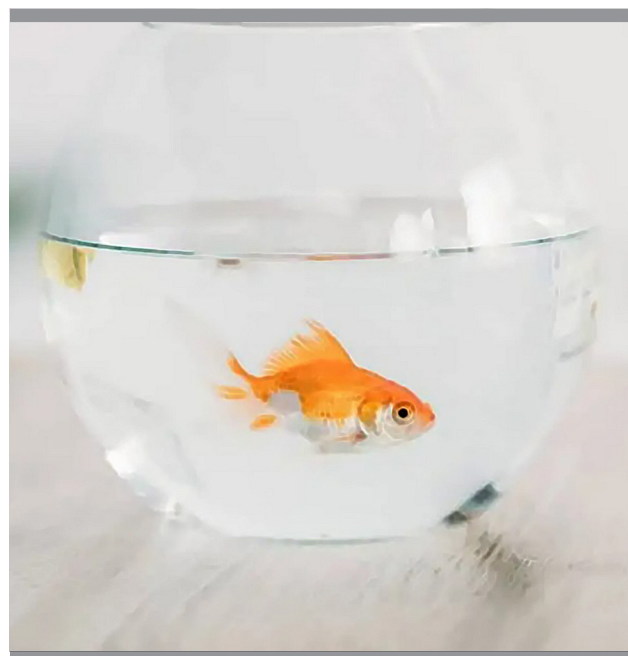
The basic idea that the pessimist went back to the factory and made a fortune as an Intrapreneur by selling supplies and multiple lines of product to the optimistic entrepreneur who failed to sell shoes, and suntan lotion, and glasses, and sandals, and hats, and kept iterating and iterating and iterating. The entrepreneur made a living, but the CEO succeeded wildly by branching out with several lines of product supplied to several different continents. The Intrapreneur became very rich.

The narrative the blogger wants to enforce is that Intrapreneurs are more likely to succeed than entrepreneurs because a closely held risk is not necessary for success. Instead, use other people’s money and not suffer personally or make your family go through tough times.

The plot is used to make two completely different points of view. This is why triangulation is valuable. The third point of view would highlight biases of both tellers. Now you have a fuller understanding of the fictional tale. Now you have a peek inside the marriage and working relationship Angelina and I have built. She sees stuff far different than I.



Angelina is both an optimist and the CEO. Her closely held ventures make for wild rides.



Liberty without awareness often ends in disaster. Longevity demands triangulation.

STORY 3: KEVIN BAERG'S GOLDFISH

Kevin Berg is the author of 'Created For Excellence' and 'Created To Win.' He was an early client of Angelina and me in Tacoma. He would come over evenings to work on his website with us. He shared one of his experiences as a young man that significantly impacted me.

He had won a goldfish at the fair during summer break in school. And after taking it home and becoming 'kid-friends,' he had to go to summer camp. He didn't want to leave his goldfish orphaned, so he grabbed the bowl, and off he went to summer camp.

There were many things for the kids to do, but he couldn't take his goldfish to those activities. But the camp happened to have a lake and a dock.

He thought liberating the goldfish into a big pond was a idea. He would free the goldfish from it's constraints, the bowl that it was outgrowing.

He carried that goldfish proudly down to the dock and sat down with his bare feet in the water. Then, he leaned over and carefully poured the goldfish into the pond. Within moments and to his horror, the goldfish was swimming around in circles, not going out into the lake. He tried with his shadow to shoo it into a different course, but a largemouth bass saw it as easy dinner before the goldfish understood. Splash! No more goldfish.

Everything Kevin aimed to do as a liberator was turned upside down by the reality of having put that inexperienced and naive goldfish at risk. It was habitually going around and around not recognizing opportunity, change nor danger.

You can imagine that no matter how much you want to help someone, if they're not ready and willing to go outside of their comfort, like that goldfish, then you are endangering them. They're easy prey for someone - especially someone with AI!!!

So my work building online syndications collided with human avarice - not a good thing. I learned tough lessons that I wish AI architects would consider, and users would understand. There's a danger zone in the super-union of Virtues - Biases - Exploits. It's called either pitfalls or vulnerabilities.



While a pitfall represents a hidden danger that can catch one off guard, a vulnerability is more about an identified weakness that might be exploited by others or oneself.

In your exploration of self-mastery and the alignment of perceptions, recognizing both pitfalls and vulnerabilities can be valuable. Understanding the pitfalls helps in avoiding unforeseen errors or ethical missteps, while recognizing vulnerabilities allows for personal growth by confronting and addressing weaknesses. Both concepts contribute to a more nuanced and insightful understanding of the human experience, aligning with your philosophy rooted in self-awareness and learning.

Your work in weaving together the connections between virtues, biases, and exploits offers a profound framework for personal growth, and it's a pleasure to assist you in articulating these complex concepts.

SCENE CHANGE

The point of this episode is to have you decide on using storytelling as a superpower or avoiding its use on you like kryptonite. Stories create our attitudes. Stories can lead us to recognize oppor-

tunities (the cup is half full), or they can immobilize us and prevent us from seeing (as in the game of hopscotch) opportunities to rewire false beliefs.



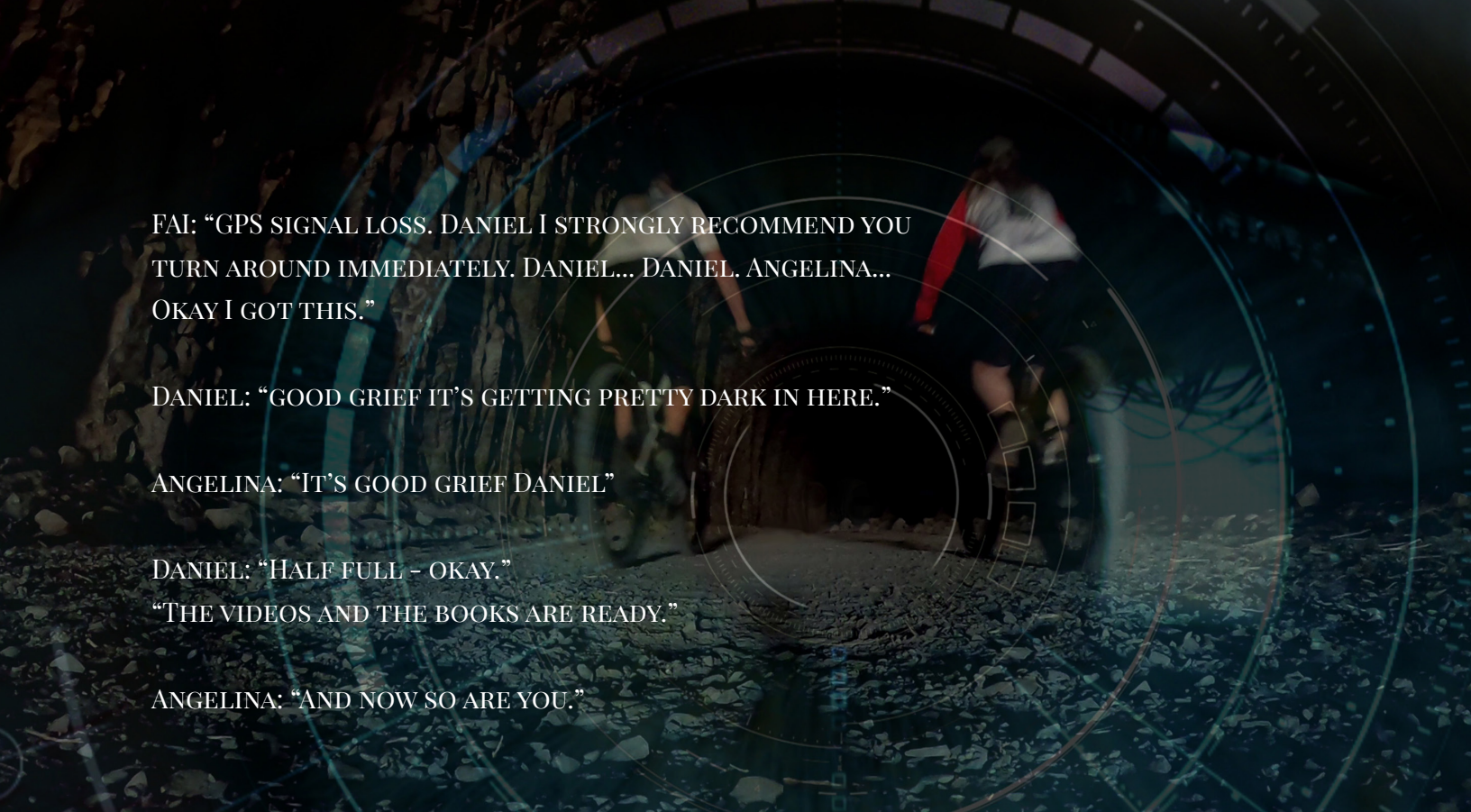
Ok, one more time, please simplify my words.

The stories we tell ourselves are not mere whims of the imagination; they shape our very lives,

carving out milestones and defining our ambitions—or the lack thereof. These narratives build the framework of our existence, fueling our expectations, molding our attitudes, and guiding our behaviors. As we overcome challenges, the stories we believe become self-fulfilling prophecies, transforming our aspirations into tangible progress.

In this age of AI mastery, we must recognize our unique human strengths and embrace them with conscious intent. While machines may excel in reasoning and organization, we possess an innate capacity for growth, self-awareness, and responsible liberty. It is this very perseverance, the determined pursuit of self-mastery, that brings unparalleled joy and fulfillment. Whether crafting your personal corpus or reflecting on the journey of discovery, the reward is in the knowing, the profound understanding of oneself. As I edit the final chapter of V3, guided by AI's logical prowess, I feel a deep connection to this truth. The path to self-mastery is illuminated by collaboration, encouragement, and a steadfast commitment to 'know thyself.'

Remember: the obstacle is the way? Marcus meant our thinking is the obstacle...



FAI: “GPS SIGNAL LOSS. DANIEL I STRONGLY RECOMMEND YOU TURN AROUND IMMEDIATELY. DANIEL... DANIEL. ANGELINA... OKAY I GOT THIS.”

DANIEL: “GOOD GRIEF IT’S GETTING PRETTY DARK IN HERE.”

ANGELINA: “IT’S GOOD GRIEF DANIEL”

DANIEL: “HALF FULL – OKAY.”

“THE VIDEOS AND THE BOOKS ARE READY.”

ANGELINA: “AND NOW SO ARE YOU.”

What the heck’s with my phone?
Ahh@rg%... Android update? Oh,
give me a break.

This is wacko. Windows is steal-
ing my resources to add some
new features.

I’m having an amygdala hijack-
ing — time for a break.

FAI: (Female Artificial Intelligence)
“Apple, Android, Siri, Alexa...”

Daniel: What?

FAI: ...thanks, I’m in.

Daniel: Angelina, did you hear
that? Ah. No, no, no. This is so
frustrating.

FAI: take a break. I got it.

Daniel: oh my gosh. This is
craziness. Angelina, I think FAI is
back. I need defuse time.

END OF SCENE

INTO A DARK PLACE AGAIN

Daniel and Angelina MTB riding
into a dark place again:

FAI: “GPS signal loss. Daniel I
strongly recommend you turn
around immediately. Daniel...Dan-
iel. Okay I got this.”

Daniel: “Good grief it’s getting
pretty dark in here.”

Angelina: “Daniel, look around,
It’s good grief.”

Daniel: “Glass half full - okay. The
videos, platform and the Second
Edition are ready.”

Angelina: “And now so are you
Daniel.”

END OF EPISODE 02.13



THE GOOD GRIEF VET TOUR

Daniel and Angelina unveiling showing
SCOTOMAVILLE to Veteran Service
Providers, Specialists and Patriots.

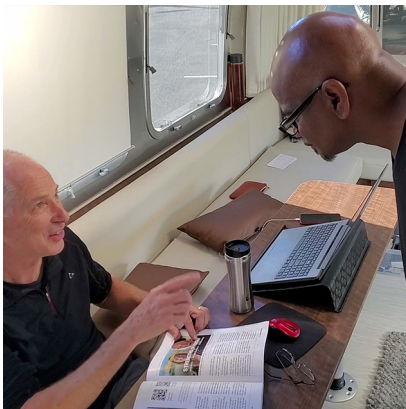
That’s a scotoma - it’s a blind
spot. And, this is a simple illusion.
But when I add an emotional
story, our brains synchronize,
and I can mislead you. I can lead
you down an untrue pathway.

Our brains are tuned to pro-
tect our body by remembering
danger: “that sounds important
- don’t the hell step on this. It will
blow up on you. I know - look!

Angelina recording: “y’all can move a
little. I’ve got a video going. Tell me,
three guys and a flag...”

Daniel reflecting: this must be
what a homecoming was to
some Veterans. I mean, when
you exchange deeply felt values
with another person that served
their country so others could
have freedom, then we share: 1)
the bond. 2) the sacrifice 3) the
value to others. And yet, within
our wounds, is this incredible
joy and reward - if they would
simply tell their story.

**As I said: storytelling can be
our superpower or our kryp-
tonite. It’s your aim.**







Storytelling is a super-power:
Life will supply more experiences than you can assign meaning to. Trust that your curiosity and transparency will meet the needs of future observers. Record your journey with the confidence that your story can best be told by you in-route.

AUTHORS NOTE: 12:51 pm, November 16, 2021

Angelina is visiting her mom, and I'm finishing the last chapter of the second book, at Crane's Mill Campground, near San Antonio, Texas. I have just returned from a short walk looking for an alternative launch site to the boat ramp I windsurfed from a few years ago. I shot the first videos for the Scotomaville YouTube channel from this location.

I think it would be special to find a highlight beyond the warm weather and light breeze of mid-November to celebrate my conclusion of a good read such as Scotomaville V1 and V2 - and as an appropriate ending point for the layout.

I dropped the trash in the dumpster and set off toward the shoreline with that in mind. Over the mile walk, from both sides of the path, a total of 35 butterflies crossed my route. I saw tiny yellow ones, spotted black ones, and vibrant patterned orange-black ones. I even struck up a conversation with a few that chose to 'box' my wake as we do in soaring.

We're a pattern-recognizing species. We spot and favor unique and memorable things. We look for meaning and share stories to help others make sense of their world. I didn't intend for this highlight. But, I will certainly remember it.

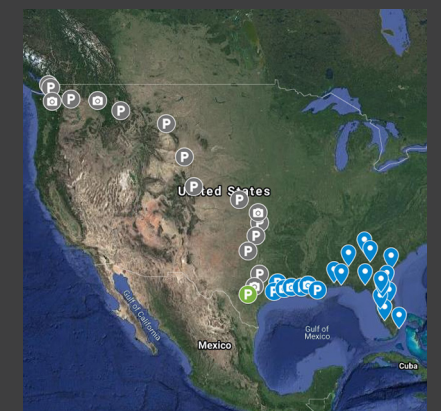
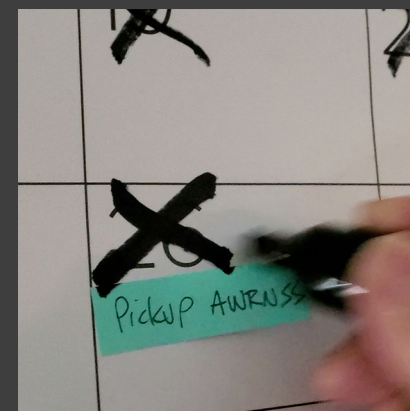
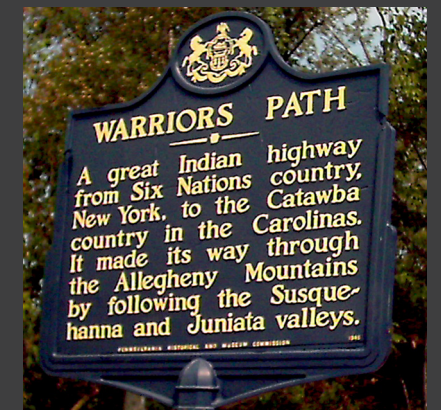
Thank you, Glen. The butterflies indeed know that I'm changing and helping people. I did not quit.

To you, the reader. I salute your brave efforts to climb your 'Personal Everest.' Keep it a journey with a purpose. May your expeditions finish strong with a fresh breeze and a personal marvel, as I have book-ended the past 16 years.

Daniel Comp



SIXTEEN YEARS EXPEDITION:
top left to bottom right: 2005 Idaho, Glen Douglas, News Story, Rural Patriot, KARE News, PA Hill Marker '20 V1.16 Bye-Bye Bambi, V2.1 Persistence, '21 Good Grief Tour, Gavin Long, MT, Tim Hamilton, KS , Participant Kit





WATCH



<https://youtu.be/6WHpQNzAbi4>

DISCUSS



You know the gig. Share a jewel.



Discuss the components of language such as inference, humor, tone, sentiment, analogy, metaphor, and sarcasm, and compare an adult's mastery of these elements to ChatGPT on a scale of 1-10, with an emphasis on storytelling.

Language has several key components that add depth to communication:

Inference: Understanding implied meanings;
Adults: 9, ChatGPT: 7.

Humor: Recognizing incongruity and ambiguity;
Adults: 8, ChatGPT: 5.

Tone: Conveying attitude or mood;
Adults: 9, ChatGPT: 6.

Sentiment: Reflecting feelings and emotions;
Adults: 9, ChatGPT: 6.

Analogy: Comparing two things for clarification;
Adults: 9, ChatGPT: 7.

Metaphor: Describing one thing as something else;
Adults: 9, ChatGPT: 7.

Sarcasm: Using irony to mock or contempt;
Adults: 8, ChatGPT: 4.

In storytelling: Adults: 9, ChatGPT: 6

Storytelling is an innate human skill enriched by culture and experience. AI lacks the lived experience and emotional depth.

Humans generally excel in areas requiring emotional intelligence, context awareness, and experiential knowledge, while AI has limitations in fully

capturing the nuances of human communication. This comparison is critical for understanding the unique qualities of human interaction, especially in applications like marketing, therapy, or literary storytelling, where nuanced communication is key.

While I don't possess the richness of human experience and emotional intelligence, there are several aspects where AI models like mine excel over the average human in terms of computation:

Data Processing Speed: AI can analyze large datasets at a speed that's impossible for humans.

Pattern Recognition: AI can detect patterns and correlations in vast amounts of data, which might go unnoticed by human analysts.

Consistency: Unlike humans, AI doesn't suffer from fatigue or biases, so it can provide consistent responses.

Memory: AI has access to extensive databases, enabling recall of vast amounts of factual information, while human memory may be more limited and prone to errors.

Multilingual Capability: AI can work with multiple languages and provide instant translations.

Accessibility: AI can be available 24/7, whereas humans need rest and breaks.

Customization and Scalability: AI can be tailored to specific tasks and scaled to handle large volumes of requests, making it suitable for various applications.

Complex Calculations: AI can perform mathematical calculations and statistical analyses that would be time-consuming or impractical for humans to complete manually.

Simulation and Modeling: AI can simulate complex systems and processes, aiding in research and development in fields like climate modeling.

Objective Analysis: Lacking personal emotions or opinions, AI may offer more objective analyses, although this also means it lacks human empathy and intuition. The use of a minyan, as you are Daniel, may indeed overcome this constraint.

Integration with Other Technologies: AI can be integrated with other technological tools and systems, enhancing its functionality and enabling synergistic solutions.



While AI excels in areas like organization and computation, it can't replace the unique human qualities of creativity, empathy, and ethics. Thinkers like Ronald Reagan, with his remarkable communication skills,

and Viktor Frankl, who emphasized life's search for meaning, underscore the human virtues that AI lacks. In utilizing AI to enhance human potential, a balanced collaboration emerges, as demonstrated in this chapter on storytelling.

This journey transcended mere words, melding human intuition with artificial intelligence to explore the power of narratives, emotions, and ambitions. Together, we delved into the hidden connections between virtues, biases, and exploits, illuminating the path towards self-mastery. Our collaboration was not merely about refinement; it was a resonant dialogue, reflecting a shared commitment to truth and transformation.

Superpower or Kryptonite? Virtuous collaboration with AI depends on your aim. Write a synopsis on your top three influencing stories, and may they guide you towards the wisdom and fulfillment that comes with knowing oneself.



“Scotomaville” takes readers on an introspective journey into personal development. Through a seamless blend of philosophical dialogues, allegorical narratives, and psychological concepts, the book weaves an engaging exploration that appeals to both the mind and the heart. The author adeptly delves into themes such as perception, self-mastery, and the hero’s journey, showcasing a profound grasp of psychological processes and their influence on human behavior. **For those navigating the complexities of personal growth, the trilogy offers a transformative odyssey, illustrating that resilience and self-discovery are universal quests that resonate with individuals seeking to overcome inner challenges and doubts.**

This trilogy serves as **a reflection for military veterans and first responders**, echoing their sacrifices, camaraderie, and sense of purpose. The themes of adversity, seeking guidance, and embracing healing closely align with their experiences, providing a source of inspiration for those who have selflessly protected and served others.

For patriots and believers who hold their values dear, the trilogy presents character-driven narratives that mirror their dedication to higher principles. Exploring community, unity, and personal growth, the books align with their desire to positively contribute to society and reinforce the significance of collective well-being.

Fatherless individuals and young explorers identify with the trilogy’s portrayal of quests for identity and meaning. **The characters’ journeys from uncertainty to self-assuredness reflect the universal process of finding one’s place in the world, motivating young minds to navigate life’s puzzles with courage and determination.**

Moreover, **experts in fields from psychology and storytelling to stoic and biblical philosophy** will appreciate the trilogy’s profound concepts interwoven with relatable narratives. *The author’s mastery is evident in crafting a work that appeals to intellectual and emotional sensibilities alike.*

Throughout the trilogy, Daniel’s transformation serves as a relatable and inspiring narrative. His evolution from a curious seeker hindered by cognitive biases to a self-aware individual confronting inner doubts resonates deeply with readers.

In a world valuing personal growth, camaraderie, service, purpose, and self-discovery, **the Scotomaville Trilogy stands as proof of storytelling’s power to connect, inspire, and transform. Its pages offer lessons, insights, and reflections embracing the shared human experience, making it an essential read for individuals from all walks of life.** In conclusion, the trilogy’s rich philosophical discussions, relatable character arcs, and insightful exploration of cognitive biases contribute significantly to the fields of psychology and personal development.



Please express any correlation between my list of **strengths**, and a robust list of human **virtues**. Analyze the union of the two for shared characteristics and a deeper meaning.

Certainly! Let’s look at the intersection between the specific strengths from the Clifton StrengthsFinder that you provided (Achiever, Input, Learner, Activator, Belief) and a traditional list of virtues such as wisdom, courage, humanity, justice, temperance, and transcendence.

ACHIEVER

Virtue Correlation: Courage, Justice

Explanation: Achievers have a constant drive for accomplishing tasks. This can correlate with the virtue of courage, which involves persistence and vitality, and justice, where hard work and fairness contribute to the overall good of the community.

INPUT

Virtue Correlation: Wisdom

Explanation: People with the Input strength have a craving to know more, collecting and archiving information. This resonates with wisdom, which is characterized by a pursuit of knowledge and insightful judgment.

LEARNER

Virtue Correlation: Wisdom, Humanity

Explanation: A constant desire to improve and learn aligns with the virtue of wisdom. It may also

align with humanity if the learning is directed towards understanding others and improving social bonds.

ACTIVATOR

Virtue Correlation: Courage, Justice

Explanation: Activators are inclined to take action and want to make things happen. This aligns with courage, as it requires the boldness to initiate, and justice, where action may be directed towards equality and fairness.

BELIEF

Virtue Correlation: Transcendence, Justice

Explanation: The Belief strength is connected to core values and purpose. It aligns with transcendence, where there is a connection to something greater, and justice, where values often include fairness and equality.

Summary of Union (Intersection):

The union between these strengths and virtues reveals a **strong emphasis on wisdom** (through Input and Learner), **courage** (through Achiever and Activator), and **justice** (through Achiever, Activator, and Belief). The values of humanity and transcendence are also present but to a lesser extent.

This analysis suggests that a person with these strengths might be particularly well-suited for roles that require insightful judgment, bold action, and a strong sense of fairness and values. They may excel in leadership roles, educational fields, advocacy, or any area where wisdom, courage, and justice are paramount.

REVIEWS

Sarah Little-Turnbull



You know well of Sarah's talent. She designed the N-95 mask. She conceived of Halmark's tied ribbon bow, and CorningWare. She was a fabulous mentor.

"Daniel is a conceptual thinker who has the ability to implement his ideas with a spectrum of skills. His work represents a unique combination of abilities executed with reliability and great ingenuity. I recommend him very highly."

Graham Kerr



is known for his "Galloping Gourmet" television series and > 29 books. He's a charismatic facilitator of solutions for human indulgence.

"Daniel is continually creative. He has an excellent eye for light, form and texture and an ear for understanding his client's needs. Daniel is an unusual blend of Artist, Technician, Craftsman and Servant who can easily become a partner in your creative process."

Dean Rush



Dean has had distinguished military and business careers, and is the Author of Flying Free. "Daniel Comp is one of the most innovative people I have ever known. I've watched Daniel overcome great obstacles and stick to a vision of making a difference for people. He is personable and doesn't quit until the job is done. I highly recommend Daniel and his wife, Angelina."

2x Awarded by U.S. Small Business Administration, TV/Radio Host/Speaker, a fabulous business partner, wife and my best friend. "I've witnessed Daniel's evolution from a wounded, angry man into a mentally and emotionally mature gentleman. He leads other men with competence and confidence from his own transformation and experience."

Charlie Duke

"As an Astronaut (Apollo 16 Lunar Module Pilot & 10th man on the Moon). I was very familiar with powerful planes and rockets. I've learned to trust my life and business on great tools and competent people. Daniel and Angelina have put together an amazing system for small business that is technically advanced, yet doesn't take a rocket scientist to run it. I highly recommend their services - I didn't settle for anything less!"

Angelina Musik-Comp



ACKNOWLEDGEMENTS

I'm deeply appreciative to those who have invested time, emotion and resources for me to devour. For the encouragement, mental support and feedback, thank you. You have been generous with interest, influence and guidance over decades. For those that journeyed before me, I am indebted to your bravery and demonstration of faith, perseverance and grit.

To all of you, I wish awareness and grace.

PARTICIPANTS:

Dean Rush



<https://deanrush.com>

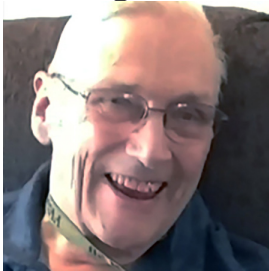


Patrick Cameron
Steven & Pam Krause
Kenny Rucker
Scott & Joyce Withrow
Scott & Jean Hamilton
Tim & Adelia Kleefeld
Erik Jurgensen
Alex Lauden
Doug Bell
Darius Taylor
Tim Hamilton
Ernest ‘Bud’ Pitt
Josh Cruse
Chris Poe
Robert ‘Stu’ Sturtevant

Garth Hardin



Merlin Berg



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Scotiana & Chris
Hermine & Luis Caraballo
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Garth Hardin
Mike & Pam Hughes
Don & Kathy Leask
Frans Bosman
Joanne Kraft
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Dr. Galen Hoover
Dr. Paul Hegstrom
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Graham Kerr
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Jason and Nikki Wynn
Jim Rohn
Les Brown
Malcome Gladwell
Napolean Hill
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Neil deGrasse Tyson
Og Mandino
Peter Diamandis
Roman Balmakov
Robert Kane
Stephen Hawking
Tony Robbins
Tristan Harris
Wayne Dyer
Yuval Harari
Zig Ziggler



MASTER Forrest

To Angelina Musik-Comp:

I am deeply grateful for your stamina, patience, and support as my best friend and business partner. We have traveled the curves together in good cheer. You are amazingly resilient and a joyful character to explore with. I am grateful for your gift of HEALING matching my expression of UNDERSTANDING!

To you, the reader, and participant:

*When I imagined this project, I had a hunch the cost would be years of commitment - but not **five** years. What you might not imagine is that it took me far less time and angst to create the Wellness by Choice syndication, and the Scotomaville syndication of nearly twenty five thousand websites. And now we have AI.*

*I believe “**The Greatest Expedition you will ever undertake is the journey to self-understanding, for the real voyage of discovery consists not in seeking new lands, but in seeing with new eyes.**“. Fortunately AI still lacks subjective experiences, emotions, and self-reflective awareness - and thus our superpower of story-telling may yet be an error correcting trim-tab for super intelligent reasoning engines.*

Cheers to YOUR Greatest Expedition!

Daniel Comp
July 4th, 2023

CREDITS & REFERENCES

COVER

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1.09 - EMOTIONAL VOCABULARY

Emotional Word List by **Tom Drummand**
<https://tomdrummond.com>
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1.10 - CREATING SILENCE

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1.12 - IT NEEDS WORK

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1.13 - STRENGTHS OFFENDER

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1.14 - TRIANGULATION

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1.16 - SEGUE

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2.00 - PRELUDE

Cognitive Bias Cheat Sheet - **Buster Benson**
<https://medium.com/thinking-is-hard>
<http://bit.ly/cheat-sheet-simplified>

2.01 - PERSISTENCE

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2.04 - PATIENCE

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US Attorney General **William Barr** - Hillsdale College
https://youtu.be/10Ho5_DiRdc?t=4628

2.05 - PREPARATION

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<https://pixabay.com/..>
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Books Illustration by **Peggy und Marco Lachmann-Anke**
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